

EH&S Standard: On-Location Photography and Filming in Stanford University General and Research Work Areas - Full Standard

Introduction

This standard sets forth a framework and process by which photography and filming can be done safely, and reflects Stanford's institutional commitment to a culture of safety. It contains both elements that are mandatory regulatory compliance and Stanford policy requirements, and voluntary best practices. Requirements appear in red typeface. The EH&S department does not approve requests for photography and filming. However, we are available to consult on projects and may serve as location safety subject matter experts, depending on risk level and given adequate notice for planning. Units, departments, and schools should develop local business processes to ensure conformance with this standard as practical. The attestation form is optional. If used, project owners or other designees should retain signed copies with project records. Media requests should not be accepted without consulting with University Communications Media Relations.

Goals

- Ensure the health and safety of media crews and participants in shooting sessions.
- Depict proper EH&S practices in Stanford labs, hazardous work environments, and other locations; capture images that promote a strong safety culture.

Scope

- Pertains especially to areas where potential hazardous materials or physical hazards are present, such as:
 - **General Work Areas:** Technical trades shops, auto shops, kitchens, loading docks, visual/performing art studios, and janitorial storage areas.
 - **Laboratories:** Research laboratories, teaching laboratories, core facilities, chemical storage rooms, waste accumulation areas, warm/cold rooms, vivaria, and machine/workshop areas within laboratories.
 - **Field Research Operations:** Boats, vehicles, wilderness settings.

Process

Step 1: Plan session to meet EH&S requirements

Ideally two weeks or more before session

- Identify participants for key roles
 - Project owner: responsible for implementing this standard as it applies to each project; may be a staff member of UComms, departmental or institute communication teams, or other staff including faculty who conduct media

- production projects; responsible for ensuring that the project is resourced, staffed, scheduled and coordinated appropriately.
- Crew lead: supervises crew and as such, responsible for crew member health and safety at location; may be Stanford and/or vendor staff.
- Location host: responsible for identifying and communicating location hazards and safety measures to other participants.
- Location safety subject matter expert (SME): responsible for facilitating safe conditions and communications including safety briefings on location; can be any person knowledgeable about the location hazards, risks, safety measures and emergency procedures (e.g., principal investigator, lab safety coordinator, lab manager, EH&S staff member, university safety partner, building manager); not necessarily an EH&S professional. Location host can also serve as location safety SME.
- Schedule the shooting session as far in advance as possible, to take place preferably during normal business hours.
- During planning and scripting, identify ways to decrease the location health and safety risks by selecting lower hazard locations (e.g., office instead of lab; biosafety level 2 instead of biosafety level 3 lab) when possible, simulating hazardous work tasks, and substituting non-hazardous for hazardous materials (e.g., water for acid). Consider alternative, representative locations during staging planning to minimize risks. Media crew equipment brought into hazardous locations should be minimally disruptive and ideally sized as small as possible.
- Plan to manage the location so that only essential participants are present (e.g., actual lab work should not take place at the same time as filming, further down the bench).
- Ensure that crew and participants meet health and safety requirements before and during session
 - *Training*
 - **All SU employees must have completed EH&S 4200, General Safety, Injury Prevention, and Emergency Preparedness in STARS.**
 - All vendor employees should have completed documented training compliant with 8 CCR 3203, Injury and Illness Prevention Program or equivalent, and be willing to provide documentation of completion.
 - *Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)*
 - Ensure that crew and participants are prepared to comply with requirements for street clothes and PPE, and are provided with the appropriate PPE (see below). Consult with the location host about required

PPE, indicated by the general workplace or laboratory PPE assessment and general conditions.

- Vendor Crew Contractual Requirements
 - **Crew members of vendor companies are required to sign the Stanford Procurement contract** which includes provisions for indemnity and personal injury insurance. This in addition to the certificate of insurance **must** be completed before the session starts.

Step 2: Conduct location walk-through and prepare safety briefing

One to two days before session

- At the direction of the project owner, the location host should walk through the location areas one day or so before the session is scheduled to start, and check for general safety conditions. This should be done in conjunction with the location safety SME and the crew lead if available. Follow the guidance below for specific reminders.

Location	General Conditions
General Work Areas	● No food/beverage/cosmetics used or stored. <u>Housekeeping:</u> ● Free of clutter, including cardboard and boxes. ● If present, ensure hazardous materials containers are labeled; closed unless actively being used. ● Free of tripping hazards (e.g. backpacks on the floor). ● No improperly used extension and electrical cords. <u>Emergency Exits/Equipment:</u> ● No blocked exits, fire extinguishers, safety eyewash/showers, hallway storage, or exit paths.
Laboratories	Meet requirements for general work areas and specific conditions below. ● No open flames. ● No material overflowing in red bags or sharps containers. All biohazard bins are firmly closed. ● Fume hoods and biosafety cabinets free of excess materials; proper use (e.g., fume hood sash at designated height) ● For lasers, beam positioned properly, free of reflection on surfaces.
Field Research Operations	Proper safeguards in place (e.g., railings).

The location host should correct unsafe conditions and behaviors during filming.

- Implement any needed corrective actions for the location to ensure safety (e.g., remove cardboard boxes, close waste bins).
 - Rescheduling may be necessary if corrections cannot be made before the session starts.
- The location host and location safety SME should identify content for the safety briefing that may be unique to the session and location.
- The safety briefing should include:
 - Requirements for escort
 - Identification of location hazards and controls
 - Instructions on prohibited activities (e.g., food and drink in labs), and safety measures (e.g., using handrails on stairs)
 - Emergency procedures (e.g., building evacuation routes, earthquake procedures, emergency notification numbers)
 - Process to report incidents, injuries or illnesses including SU-17 completion
 - Contact information for location safety SME

Step 3: Confirm safe conditions and deliver safety briefing

Day of session

- Confirm that location reflects safe conditions and that no new hazards have been introduced.
 - Postpone the session if needed to maintain location safety.
- Deliver the safety briefing.
 - Can be done by the location host, the location safety SME or designee.
 - Allow at least 15 minutes for the safety briefing with the crew, models, actors, and other participants.
- **All crew members and guests must follow the safety and PPE rules established by the location host**, and should be accompanied by a designated host escort.
 - The location safety SME is not required to be present during the full duration of the shooting session, but should be available as needed.
- **All participants regardless of role (e.g. researcher, model, photographer, lighting person, observer) who enter hazardous locations must wear:**
 - **Safety glasses**
 - **Proper street clothing: long pants (or equivalent, including uniforms and coveralls) that completely cover the legs and ankles, and closed-toe, non-perforated shoes that completely cover the feet. No shorts, no capris, no leggings, no sandals, no ballet flats, no mesh sneakers.**

- Proper PPE for the location, according to the table below
 - PPE must properly fit the person (coats, gloves, masks etc).
 - All PPE requirements must be met, even when the shooting scenario is staged, props are used, and non-hazardous material (e.g., water) is used as a substitute for hazardous materials.

Location	Minimum PPE
General Work Areas	● Proper street clothing ● Safety glasses if required by tasks depicted ● Prescription glasses do not constitute safety eyewear; use safety glasses or goggles over prescription eyewear ● Other PPE, as required, such as hearing protectors in high noise locations; hard hats and safety shoes in construction zones
Laboratories	● Appropriate street clothing ● Safety glasses or safety goggles ● Fully buttoned lab coat ● Gloves to match the hazard; ensure skin does not show between the gloves and lab coat ● Face protection if needed
Field Research Operations	● Life jackets on boats ● Seat belts in vehicles

- People appearing in images should be shown wearing proper street clothing and the minimum PPE listed.
 - Hair longer than shoulder length should be tied back, or covered with protective head gear (e.g. hair net).
 - Jewelry and accessories should be removed where there may be potential for entanglement (e.g., necklaces, ties, or scarves near power tools/machinery).
- Once the session begins, maintain the location in a stable condition, free of the recognized hazards
 - Should hazardous conditions emerge, or a previously unrecognized hazard becomes apparent, pause session; correct hazards and conditions; re-evaluate; and resume session if safe to do so.

Step 4: Review images for compliance with EH&S requirements

- Ensure that images reflect proper EH&S practices and promote a culture of safety.
 - Edit, correct, re-film, or omit non-compliant images.

Attestation of Understanding

Key participants below acknowledge and attest to their understanding of this standard.

Project Owner:

Name	Title	Affiliation	Date

Signature

Crew Lead:

Name	Title	Affiliation	Date

Signature

Location Host:

Name	Title	Affiliation	Date

Signature

Location Safety SME:

Name	Title	Affiliation	Date

Signature

EH&S Film and Photography Safety Standard Checklist

Prior to Session:

- ☐ Review the photography and videography safety standard document.
- ☐ Identify participants for key roles, to distribute photography and videography standard document to them, and gather signatures for the attestation of understanding.
- ☐ Confirm shoot location, date, and time with a push for during business hours.
- ☐ Confirm that only shoot participants will be present at that time (i.e., non-session work tasks and operations not in progress).
- ☐ Conduct walk-through with the location host; identify and correct hazards; ensure general safety conditions are met (see table, page 3).
- ☐ Prepare information for the safety briefing.
- ☐ If applicable, ensure that outside vendor crew has sent certificate of insurance with Stanford University Procurement/Legal. (On-site work cannot proceed without required documentation.)

Day of Session:

- ☐ Confirm safety conditions from walk-through are met and area is clean/organized.
- ☐ Delivery safety briefing to on-site participants.
- ☐ Ensure all participants are wearing proper street clothing and PPE for the location.
- ☐ Ensure that images comply with safety requirements, and promote a culture of safety.